

User Story 3.2: Ontology-Style Drill-Through Navigation

As a Sourcing Associate, I want to navigate from a supplier or category (identified via spend filtering) to related contracts, then to related invoices, so I can investigate without re-querying from scratch.

Description:

Enable users to traverse from a supplier or category - identified through the spend view's filtering (Story 3.1) - into related contract records, then further into related invoice records, within a single continuous navigation flow rather than starting a new search at each step.

Narrative:

Once a user has filtered the spend view down to a specific supplier or category (via Story 3.1), the natural next step is to understand what's governing that spend - what contracts exist, and what invoices have been generated under them. This mirrors Palantir's ontology approach, letting users move fluidly between connected object types rather than treating them as isolated reports. Design should explicitly reference Palantir's ontology UX (Amy has existing access to inform this) so the interaction pattern feels familiar to users, rather than introducing a novel navigation paradigm - particularly relevant given users may be moving between both tools during the parallel-build evaluation.

Business Value:

Reduces time associates spend manually cross-referencing systems to investigate spend context - whether starting from a supplier or a category. Also reduces user friction and relearning cost by keeping the navigation pattern consistent with what users already expect from Palantir, supporting the broader parity goal of feeling comparable, not just functioning comparably.

Acceptance Criteria:

- Given a user has filtered the spend view to a specific supplier or category (per Story 3.1), when they select it, then related contracts are shown
- Given a selected contract, when a user drills further, then related invoices under that contract are shown
- Given a user has drilled down multiple levels, when they want to return to a higher level, then they can navigate back up without losing their place or needing to re-filter
- Given a user has used Palantir's ontology drill-through, when using this drill-through, then the interaction pattern (clicking into a related object, back navigation) feels familiar, not novel

Out of Scope:

- *Drilling from location to contracts/invoices - open question, not committed (see prior note on location granularity)*
- Drilling into OCR-extracted line-item detail within an invoice (dependent on Document Digitization)
- Persona-based or role-specific entry points into this drill-through flow
- Pixel-for-pixel visual replication of Palantir's interface - this is about interaction pattern consistency, not visual design matching